

Customer Handling Protocol

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Purpose

This protocol defines how the Customer Relations Officer conducts customer follow-up calls, complaint intake, and satisfaction surveys. It provides a consistent method for recording customer contact and ensuring that promised actions and serious complaints are visible to the responsible teams.

The protocol applies to customer-care activities following vehicle delivery and to customer feedback received through the Customer Care function. The required records are maintained in the DMS so that customer interactions can be reviewed when follow-up is required.

Customer interactions should be handled in a clear and respectful manner. The Customer Relations Officer should record the customer's information accurately and avoid changing the customer's description of a complaint into an interpretation that was not provided by the customer.

Effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. Reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Follow-up Cadence

The standard follow-up cadence consists of a Day-1 satisfaction call after delivery, a week-2 usage check, and a month-3 service reminder. These contacts provide defined points at which the Customer Relations Officer checks the customer's experience and records relevant information.

The Day-1 satisfaction call takes place after the vehicle has been delivered. The purpose of the call is to obtain an initial customer response following delivery and to identify any issue that requires attention.

The week-2 usage check focuses on the customer's early use of the vehicle. The Customer Relations Officer should record relevant feedback and identify any promised action arising from the conversation.

The month-3 service reminder provides a later customer contact associated with the vehicle's service timeline. The reminder and its outcome should be recorded in the DMS in the same manner as the other scheduled contacts.

Every call outcome is logged in the DMS with a sentiment tag and any promised action. The record should be completed after the call so that the outcome is available to the Customer Care team.

A call record should distinguish between what the customer reported, what action was promised, and what follow-up is required. Where an action is promised, the Customer Relations Officer should ensure that the action is recorded clearly enough for the responsible person or department to understand what is expected.

If a scheduled customer contact cannot be completed, the outcome should be recorded in the DMS rather than leaving the interaction without a status. The Customer Relations Officer should follow

the department's established follow-up process for the next contact where applicable.

1. Follow-up Cadence — DMS Records

DMS entries should contain the relevant outcome of the customer interaction and the required sentiment tag. The record should be sufficiently clear for another authorized Customer Care employee to understand what occurred without relying on an undocumented verbal explanation.

Promised actions should be recorded at the time they are identified. The action description should state what was promised rather than using a general note such as 'customer issue' or 'follow up later.'

When an action is completed, the Customer Care record should be updated according to the department's normal DMS process. This allows the department to distinguish open promised actions from completed customer-care activities.

Customer feedback that indicates dissatisfaction should not be removed or rewritten simply because the issue was later resolved. The original customer interaction and the subsequent action remain useful parts of the customer-care record.

The Customer Relations Officer should use the defined cadence consistently so that customer contacts are not performed only when a problem has already been reported. Each scheduled contact has a separate point in the customer relationship.

2. Complaint Intake

Complaints are logged with a time-stamp, complaint description in the customer's own words, department attribution, and severity rating. These fields provide the basic information required to route and review a complaint.

The complaint description should preserve the customer's wording as closely as practical. The Customer Relations Officer should avoid replacing the customer's statement with assumptions about the cause of the complaint.

The time-stamp records when the complaint was received. It is important for complaints requiring escalation because the escalation requirement is measured from the time the complaint is received.

Department attribution identifies the department associated with the complaint. The attribution should be based on the information available during intake and should be updated through the appropriate process if later review establishes a different responsible department.

Every complaint must receive a severity rating. The rating allows Customer Care to identify complaints requiring immediate management attention and distinguish them from complaints that can proceed through the normal handling process.

2. Complaint Intake — Severity-1

Severity-1 complaints are complaints involving safety or financial matters. These complaints are escalated to the Branch Manager within one hour.

The one-hour escalation requirement begins when the Severity-1 complaint is identified and logged. The Customer Relations Officer should not delay escalation while attempting to obtain

unnecessary additional information.

The initial complaint record should contain the available facts, the customer's own description, the relevant department attribution, the severity rating, and the time-stamp. Additional information can be added through the normal record process as it becomes available.

When escalating a Severity-1 complaint, the Customer Relations Officer should make the urgency clear and ensure that the Branch Manager receives the information required to understand the nature of the complaint.

The escalation itself should remain traceable through the department's customer-care records. If the complaint results in a promised action, the action should also be recorded so that it is not lost after the initial escalation.

2. Complaint Intake — Ongoing Handling

After intake, complaints should remain visible to the responsible Customer Care personnel until the required handling or follow-up has been completed. A complaint should not be treated as closed merely because it has been forwarded to another department.

Where Customer Care promises the customer a follow-up, the promised action should be recorded in the DMS. The record should make it possible to identify what the customer was told and what action remains outstanding.

If a complaint is transferred to another department, the department attribution should provide a clear indication of where the matter is being handled. Customer Care should retain the relevant complaint record according to the DMS process.

Customer complaints should be handled consistently regardless of whether the customer contacts the organization by telephone or through another approved customer-care channel. The required complaint information should still be captured in the applicable DMS record.

Employees handling complaints should avoid making unsupported commitments about outcomes, timing, refunds, repairs, or other actions. Where a matter requires another department's decision, the customer should be given only information that the Customer Relations Officer is authorized to provide.

3. Surveys

The monthly CSI survey is a mandatory 12-question script. The Customer Relations Officer must complete surveys for at least 60 percent of the month's delivered vehicles.

The 12-question script should be used as the defined monthly survey instrument rather than being shortened or replaced with an informal conversation. Consistent use of the script allows the collected customer responses to be compared using the same question set.

The monthly survey activity should be planned against the number of vehicles delivered during the month so that the 60 percent minimum coverage requirement can be achieved.

The Customer Relations Officer should maintain a clear record of completed survey contacts in the DMS or the designated customer-care record. The record should allow the department to identify which delivered vehicles have received the required survey contact.

Survey responses should be recorded accurately. The Customer Relations Officer should not change a customer's response in order to improve the apparent survey result.

If a customer declines to participate or cannot be reached, the outcome should be recorded according to the available DMS process. Such an outcome should not be treated as a completed survey unless the required survey has actually been completed.

3. Surveys — Monthly Coverage

The 60 percent requirement is calculated against the month's delivered vehicles. Customer Care should monitor completed survey activity during the month rather than waiting until the final days to determine whether the required coverage has been reached.

Survey activity should be distributed across the month where practical so that customer contacts are managed in an orderly way. The department should identify gaps in coverage early enough to perform remaining eligible contacts.

The Customer Relations Officer should use the approved 12-question script consistently. Any required clarification about the script should be directed to the document owner rather than creating an alternative survey format.

Monthly survey records should be retained so that the department can demonstrate the number of delivered vehicles considered and the number for which the required survey was completed.

Customer Interaction Records

Customer-care records are maintained to provide a traceable history of follow-up calls, complaint intake, promised actions, and survey activity. Records should be accurate and entered in a timely manner.

The DMS is the required location for logging follow-up call outcomes. Customer Relations Officers should avoid relying on personal notes as the final record of a customer interaction.

A DMS entry should contain enough information to distinguish the interaction from other customer contacts. The sentiment tag and promised action should be entered where required by the follow-up protocol.

Complaint records require particular attention to the customer's own words, the time-stamp, department attribution, and severity rating. These fields should remain clear enough to support escalation and subsequent review.

Survey records should provide evidence of monthly completion against the delivered-vehicle population. Customer Care should retain the relevant information in accordance with its normal DMS recordkeeping process.

Customer Care Responsibilities

The Customer Relations Officer is responsible for carrying out the defined follow-up cadence, recording call outcomes, logging complaints, applying the required severity rating, escalating Severity-1 complaints within one hour, and completing the monthly CSI survey requirement.

Customer Care personnel should treat customer information carefully and use the DMS only through the access and processes provided by the organization. Records should be factual and should reflect the actual customer interaction.

Where an issue requires another department's involvement, Customer Care should record the relevant department attribution and any promised action rather than leaving the matter without a documented next step.

The Customer Relations Officer should seek clarification from the document owner when the correct handling of a situation is unclear. This helps keep customer-care records consistent with the approved protocol.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the Customer Care department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner.

The document is reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. The current version should be used for customer-care activities covered by this protocol.

Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual. Employees responsible for customer-care activities are expected to follow the defined follow-up, complaint intake, escalation, and survey requirements.